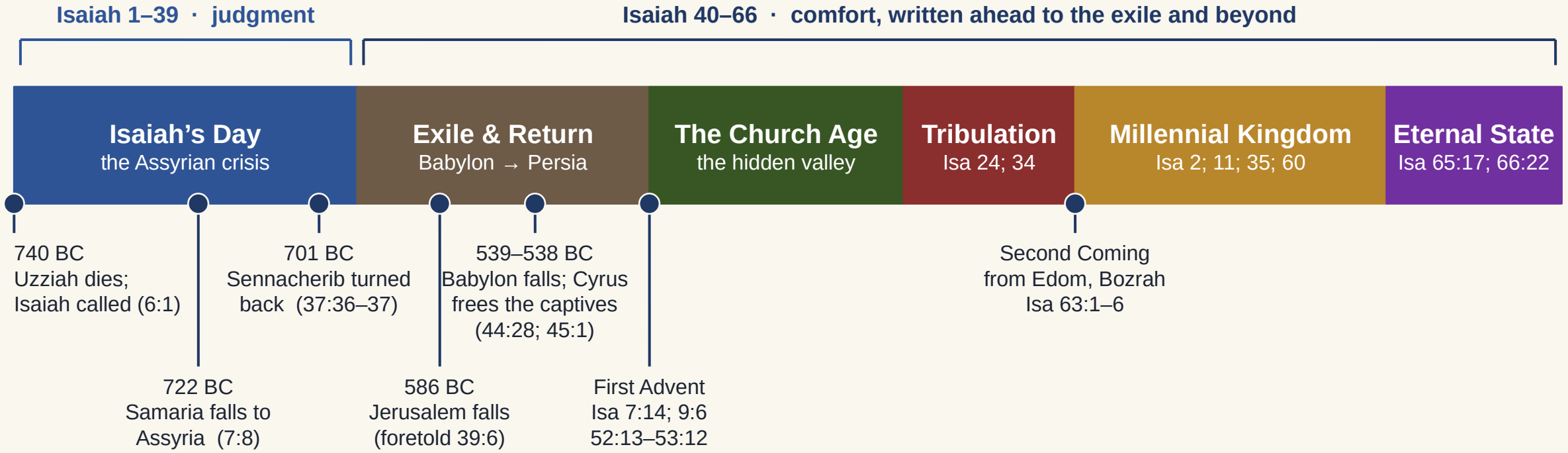
Isaiah at a Glance

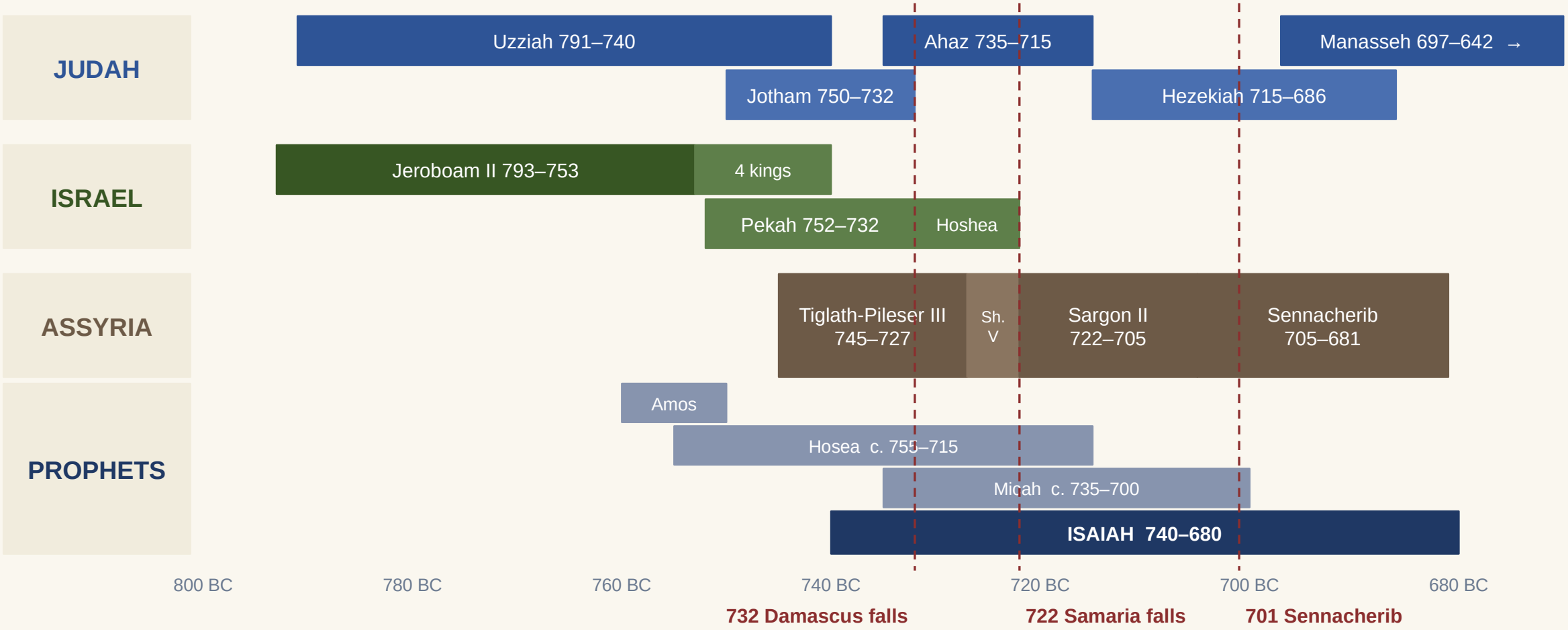
From Isaiah's call to the new heavens and new earth · not to scale



The prophet saw Messiah's sufferings (ch. 53) and His glory (ch. 11) on one horizon; the Church Age between them was not yet revealed (see Prophecy Chart 10, the Two-Mountain View).

Kings and Prophets in Isaiah's Day

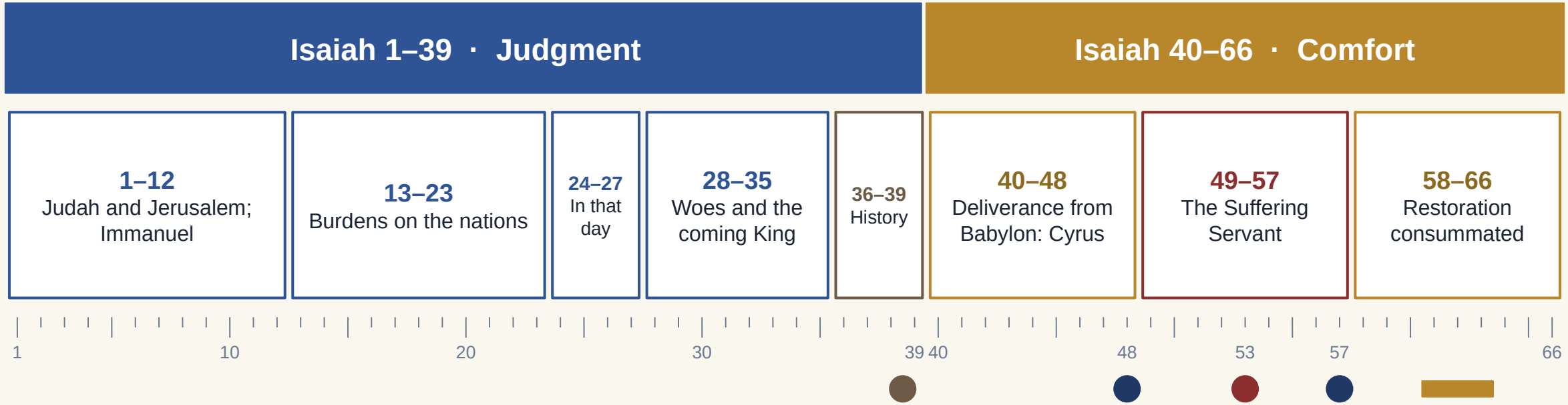
Judah, Israel, Assyria and the eighth-century prophets, 800–670 BC



Isaiah to Judah; Micah to Judah; Amos and Hosea to the Northern Kingdom. Reigns overlap where a son ruled with his father.

The Shape of the Book

Sixty-six chapters in two great movements: judgment, then comfort



48:22 and 57:21
"There is no peace," says the LORD, "for the wicked" — the refrain that closes 40–48 and 49–57

52:13–53:12
The Suffering Servant, at the center of chapters 40–66

61–63
The heart of 58–66: the coming of Messiah

36–39
History: the hinge between Assyria (36–37) and Babylon (39)

Book order is not always time order: the notes date Hezekiah's illness and Babylon's envoys (38–39) before Sennacherib's siege (36–37), all in 701 BC.

Messiah in Isaiah: The First Advent

The sufferings: prophecies fulfilled when Christ came the first time

1	**7:14** Born of a virgin: “Immanuel,” God with us	Matt 1:22–23
2	**8:14; 28:16** The stone: stumbling stone and sure foundation	Rom 9:33; 1 Pet 2:6–8
3	**9:1–2** A great light dawns in Galilee	Matt 4:13–16
4	**9:6** “A child is born, a Son is given”	Luke 2:11
5	**11:1–2** Shoot from Jesse; the Spirit rests on Him	Acts 13:23; Matt 3:16
6	**22:22** The key of the house of David	Rev 3:7
7	**35:5–6** The blind see, the deaf hear, the lame leap	Matt 11:4–5
8	**40:3** A voice in the wilderness prepares His way	Matt 3:3; John 1:23
9	**40:11** The Shepherd gathers the lambs	John 10:11
10	**42:1–4** The gentle, Spirit-anointed Servant	Matt 12:17–21
11	**49:6** A light to the Gentiles	Luke 2:32; Acts 13:47
12	**50:6** His back to the smiters; His face to spitting	Matt 26:67; 27:30
13	**52:13–53:12** Wounded for our transgressions; bore the sin of many	Acts 8:32–35; 1 Pet 2:22–25
14	**55:3** The sure mercies of David	Acts 13:34
15	**61:1–2a** Anointed to preach good news — He stopped mid-verse	Luke 4:16–21
16	**62:11** “Behold, your salvation comes”	Matt 21:5

In Nazareth Jesus read Isaiah 61:1–2a and stopped before “the day of vengeance” (61:2b), which waits for His return (see Prophecy Chart 11).

Messiah in Isaiah: The Second Advent

The glories: prophecies that wait for Christ's return and kingdom

1	**2:2–4** Nations stream to the LORD's house; swords into plowshares	Mic 4:1–3
2	**4:2** The Branch of the LORD, beautiful and glorious	Jer 23:5; Zech 6:12
3	**9:7** On David's throne: no end to His government	Luke 1:32–33
4	**11:3–10** Judges in righteousness; the wolf with the lamb	Rev 19:11
5	**11:11–12** Regathers Israel a second time	Matt 24:31
6	**16:5** A throne in the tent of David, established in mercy	Amos 9:11
7	**25:8** Swallows up death forever; wipes away tears	1 Cor 15:54
8	**32:1** A King will reign in righteousness	Jer 23:5–6
9	**33:17** Your eyes will see the King in His beauty	Rev 22:4
10	**49:7** Kings will see and arise; princes will bow	Phil 2:10–11
11	**59:20** The Redeemer will come to Zion	Rom 11:26
12	**60:1–3** The glory of the LORD rises on Zion; nations come to her light	Rev 21:23–24
13	**61:2b–3** The day of vengeance of our God	2 Thess 1:7–8
14	**63:1–6** Comes from Edom, His garments stained red	Rev 19:13–15

See Prophecy Chart 24 (from Bozrah to the Mount of Olives, Isaiah 63) and Chart 31 (Isaiah 2 and Micah 4).

The Syro-Ephraimite Crisis

Isaiah 7–8 · Aram and Israel against Judah, about 735–732 BC · schematic map



1 The alliance

Rezin of Aram and Pekah of Israel march on Jerusalem to set up a puppet king (7:1–6)

2 At the upper pool

Isaiah and his son Shear-jashub meet Ahaz: “If you will not believe, you surely shall not last” (7:3–9)

3 The sign refused

Ahaz will not ask for a sign; God gives one anyway: Immanuel (7:10–16)

4 Ahaz turns to Assyria

Assyria takes Damascus in 732 BC; Samaria falls in 722 BC (8:4; 2 Kings 16:7–9; 17:6)

Thirty-three years later Hezekiah faces Assyria at the same upper pool (36:2) — and trusts the LORD.

Isaiah’s Sign-Children

“I and the children whom the LORD has given me are for signs” (8:18)

Shear-jashub

“A remnant shall return”

Isaiah 7:3

Goes with Isaiah to meet Ahaz at the upper pool. His name is the message: Judah will not be destroyed; a remnant will return (cf. 10:20–22).

Immanuel

“God with us”

Isaiah 7:14; 8:8, 10

Near: before the child is grown, the alliance of Rezin and Pekah is broken. Far: born of a virgin — Jesus Christ (Matt 1:22–23).

Maher-shalal-hash-baz

“Quick pickings, easy prey”

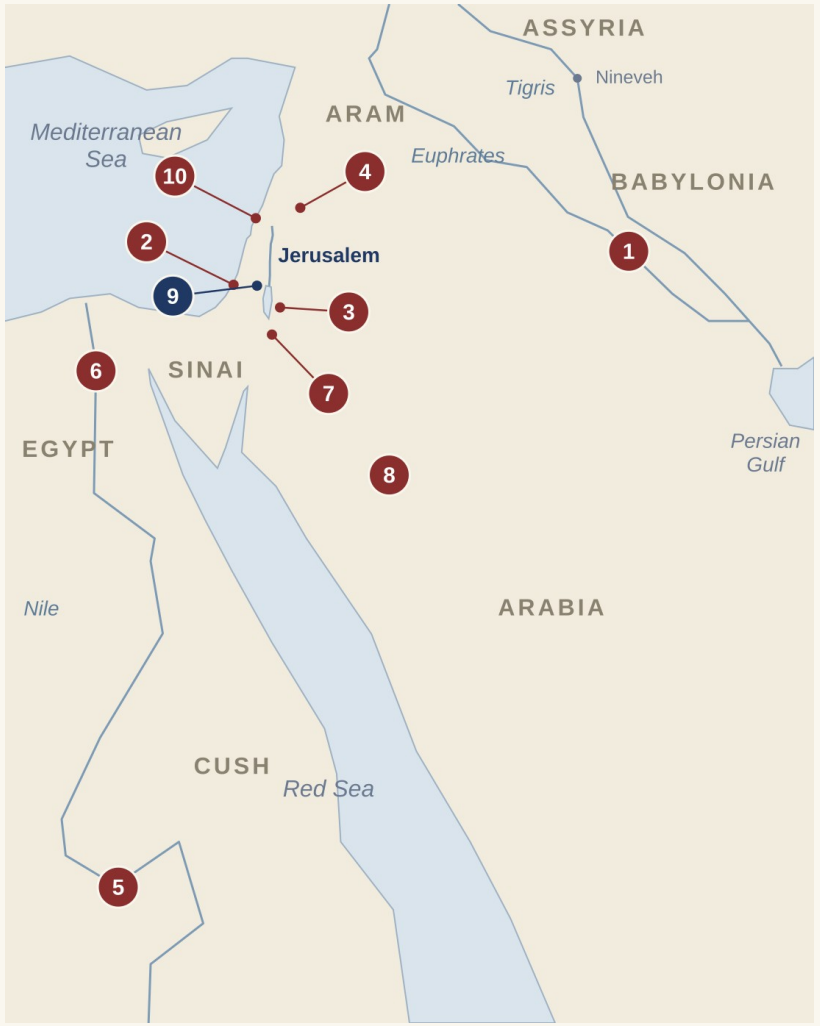
Isaiah 8:1–4

Before he can say “father” or “mother,” Assyria plunders Damascus and Samaria (732 BC). The longest personal name in the Bible.

Isaiah’s own name means “the LORD is salvation.” Father and sons together were a living sermon to Judah.

The Burdens on the Nations

Isaiah 13–23 · ten oracles, from Babylon to Tyre · schematic map



1 Babylon 13:1–14:27 (21:1–10)

Overthrown by the Medes (13:17); the king of Babylon brought down

2 Philistia 14:28–32

Given the year Ahaz died: do not rejoice that the rod is broken

3 Moab 15:1–16:14

Ar and Kir fall in a night; within three years Moab's glory is degraded

4 Damascus (Aram) 17:1–14

Rezin's capital, allied with Israel, ceases to be a city

5 Cush (Ethiopia) 18:1–7

Envoys in papyrus vessels; a gift brought to Mount Zion

6 Egypt 19:1–20:6

Isaiah walks stripped three years: Egypt cannot save Judah

7 Edom (Dumah) 21:11–12

"Watchman, what of the night?"

8 Arabia 21:13–17

Dedan, Tema and Kedar; Kedar's splendor ends within a year

9 Jerusalem 22:1–25

The "valley of vision": feasting while the city is threatened

10 Tyre 23:1–18

The great Phoenician seaport and its trade brought low

God rules the nations Judah feared or trusted. Locations approximate.

Near and Far in the Burdens

Some oracles were fulfilled in Isaiah's near future; some also look to "that day"

ORACLE	NEAR · in Isaiah's era	FAR · "in that day"
Babylon Isaiah 13–14	Overthrown by the Medes, 539 BC (13:17–22)	The Day of the LORD, the Tribulation (13:6–13); Israel restored and singing over the fallen king (14:1–4)
Moab Isaiah 15–16	Within three years Moab's glory is degraded (16:14)	—
Damascus Isaiah 17	Rezin's alliance broken; Damascus plundered, 732 BC (17:1–3; 8:4)	—
Cush Isaiah 18	Assyria cut down like pruned branches (18:5–6)	A gift brought to Mount Zion — possibly in the millennium (18:7)
Egypt Isaiah 19–20	Isaiah's three-year sign: Egypt led away by Assyria (20:3–4)	Egypt and Assyria worship with Israel "in that day" (19:18–25)
Tyre Isaiah 23	Trade cut off for "seventy years," about 700–630 BC (23:15–17)	—

A dash: the notes place that burden in Isaiah's near history. Isaiah often joins a near judgment to a far one (compare Chart 1).

“In That Day”: Isaiah 24–27

The earth judged, the dragon slain, and the kingdom opened

Tribulation	Second Coming	Millennial Kingdom
24:1–3 The earth laid waste and emptied	**27:1** The LORD slays Leviathan, the twisting serpent, with His sword	**25:6** A feast for all peoples on Mount Zion
24:19–20 A worldwide earthquake: the earth reels like a drunkard	**24:23** The LORD of hosts reigns on Mount Zion	**25:8** Death swallowed up forever; tears wiped away
24:21–22 The LORD punishes the host on high and the kings of the earth		**25:9** “This is our God; we have waited for Him”
26:17–18 Israel in labor, like a woman giving birth		**26:1–3** A strong city; perfect peace for the steadfast mind
26:20–21 “Hide yourself … until the indignation is past”		**26:19** Israel’s dead will live
		27:2–6 The vineyard kept and fruitful, filling the world
		27:12–13 The great trumpet: Israel gathered from the Euphrates to Egypt

“First comes the tribulation, chapter 24. Then comes the millennial kingdom.” — the notes on 25:1

Six Woes and the Coming King

Isaiah 28–33 · misplaced trust, and God's answer

1. 28:1 **Woe: Ephraim's drunkards**
   The proud crown of Samaria, soon trampled
2. 29:1 **Woe: Ariel — Jerusalem**
   Worship by rote; hearts far from God (29:13)
3. 29:15 **Woe: Those who hide plans from the LORD**
   The clay questioning the potter (29:16)
4. 30:1 **Woe: Rebellious children**
   Off to Egypt without asking the LORD
5. 31:1 **Woe: Those who trust Egypt's horses**
   Chariots instead of the Holy One of Israel
6. 33:1 **Woe: The destroyer — Assyria**
   The destroyer will itself be destroyed

GOD'S ANSWER

28:16 A tested cornerstone, a sure foundation in Zion

30:15 "In returning and rest you shall be saved"

30:18 The LORD waits to be gracious to you

32:1 A King will reign in righteousness

33:17 Your eyes will see the King in His beauty

33:22 The LORD is our Judge, Lawgiver and King

"Woe" appears 22 times in Isaiah, more than in any other prophetic book.

Sennacherib's Campaign, 701 BC

Isaiah 36–37 · 2 Kings 18–19 · schematic map



1 Down the coast

"In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah" Sennacherib takes the fortified cities of Judah (36:1)

2 From Lachish

The Rabshakeh is sent to Jerusalem with a great army (36:2)

3 At the upper pool

He mocks Hezekiah's trust, where Isaiah once met Ahaz (36:2–20; 7:3)

4 At Libnah

Sennacherib hears that Tirhakah of Cush is coming (37:8–9); Hezekiah spreads the letter before the LORD (37:14–20)

5 Home to Nineveh

The angel of the LORD strikes 185,000; Sennacherib returns, later killed by his sons (37:36–38)

Hezekiah's Three Crises

In the order they happened · all in 701 BC, according to the notes

Book order: 36–37 → 38 → 39 **Order of events: 38 → 39 → 36–37**

1 Illness

Isaiah 38 · 2 Kings 20:1–11

"Set your house in order." Hezekiah prays and is given fifteen more years. The sign: the shadow goes back ten steps (38:8). His song of thanksgiving (38:9–20).

›

2 Babylon's envoys

Isaiah 39 · 2 Kings 20:12–19

Merodach-baladan's envoys arrive. Hezekiah shows them everything. Isaiah: all of it will be carried to Babylon (39:6).

›

3 Assyria's siege

Isaiah 36–37 · 2 Kings 18:13–19:37

The Rabshakeh mocks at the upper pool. Hezekiah spreads the letter before the LORD. The angel of the LORD strikes 185,000.

Placed last, chapter 39 turns the book from Assyria to Babylon — the setting of chapters 40–66.

Cyrus and the Road Home

Isaiah 41–48 · the deliverer named in advance · schematic map



1 **One from the east**

God stirs up Cyrus of Persia: “My shepherd,” “His anointed” (41:2; 44:28; 45:1)

2 **Babylon falls, 539 BC**

The river dried up (44:27); Bel bows down, Nebo stoops (46:1)

3 **The decree, 538 BC**

“You shall be built” (44:28; 2 Chron 36:22–23; Ezra 1:1–4)

4 **The road home**

“Go forth from Babylon! Flee from the Chaldeans!” (48:20)

God named Cyrus and his work long before he was born — proof that the LORD alone declares the end from the beginning (46:10).

The Living God and the Idols

Isaiah 40–48 · “To whom will you liken Me?” (40:18, 25; 46:5)

THE IDOLS	THE LORD
Made by a craftsman from half a log; the other half cooks his dinner (44:9–17)	Made the heavens and stretched out the earth (40:12, 26; 44:24)
Must be carried on weary animals: Bel bows, Nebo stoops (46:1–2)	Carries His people from birth to old age (46:3–4)
Set in its place, it cannot move (46:7)	Sits above the circle of the earth (40:22)
Cannot tell what is past or what is coming (41:21–24)	Declares the end from the beginning; names Cyrus in advance (46:9–10; 44:28)
Cannot answer or save in trouble (45:20; 46:7)	“Besides Me there is no Savior” (43:11; 45:21–22)
Its makers will be put to shame (44:9–11; 45:16)	“I am the First and I am the Last” (44:6)

The Four Servant Songs

The Servant who succeeds where the servant nation failed · Isaiah 42–53

SONG	THE SERVANT IN ISAIAH	FULFILLED IN CHRIST
Song 1 **Isaiah 42:1–9**	Chosen, upheld and Spirit-anointed; quiet and gentle, He brings justice to the nations	Matt 12:17–21; 3:16–17
Song 2 **Isaiah 49:1–13**	Called from the womb; restores Jacob and is a light to the Gentiles. Named “Israel” (49:3)	Luke 2:30–32; Acts 13:47
Song 3 **Isaiah 50:4–11**	The obedient disciple: His ear opened, His back given to the smiters, His face set like flint	Matt 26:67; 27:26; Luke 9:51
Song 4 **Isaiah 52:13–53:12**	Marred, despised, wounded for our transgressions, silent as a lamb, then highly exalted	Acts 8:32–35; 1 Pet 2:22–25

The servant nation blind and deaf to its calling (42:19)

The Servant “I was not rebellious” (50:5): obedient to the Father’s will

Isaiah 52:13–53:12: Who Is Speaking?

God speaks of “My Servant”; Israel confesses “we” and “our”

GOD SPEAKS 52:13–15	“My Servant” will prosper and be exalted; His appearance marred more than any man; He will sprinkle many nations, and kings will shut their mouths.
ISRAEL SPEAKS 53:1–9	“Who has believed our report?” Despised and rejected; He bore our griefs; wounded for our transgressions; all we like sheep have gone astray; silent as a lamb; His grave with the rich.
THE LORD’S PURPOSE 53:10–12	It pleased the LORD to bruise Him, an offering for sin; He will see His seed; “My righteous Servant shall justify many”; He bore the sin of many and intercedes.

QUOTED IN THE NEW TESTAMENT

- **52:15** Rom 15:21
- **53:1** John 12:38; Rom 10:16
- **53:4** Matt 8:17
- **53:5–6** 1 Pet 2:24–25
- **53:7–8** Acts 8:32–33
- **53:9** 1 Pet 2:22
- **53:12** Luke 22:37

One Servant, innocent, suffering in the place of others: “He was wounded for our transgressions” (53:5).

Israel, the Wife of Jehovah

The marriage picture behind Isaiah 50, 54 and 62

The Marriage	The Great Adultery	Separation	The Divorce	The Punishment	The Remarriage
Ex 19:1–8; Ezek 16:8	Jer 3:1–5, 20; Ezek 16:15–34	Isa 50:1	Jer 3:6–10	Ezek 16:35–43; Hos 2:6–13	Jer 31:31–34; Isa 54:1–8; 62:4–5

WHAT ISAIAH ADDS

50:1 Sent away, not forsaken

“Where is your mother’s certificate of divorce?” She was sent away for her own sins — for a time.

54:5–8 “Your Maker is your husband”

“For a mere moment I have forsaken you, but with great mercies I will gather you.”

62:4–5 New names

“Forsaken” becomes Hephzibah, “My delight is in her”; “Desolate” becomes Beulah, “Married.”

Idolatry was Israel’s adultery; the remarriage rests on the New Covenant (Jer 31:31–34).